ARDMORE PARISH

Parish Newsletter

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME • 25 OCTOBER 2026 • YEAR A

Gospel Reflection | Matthew 22:34–40

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognise the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

Prayer for the Week • May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Sunday Readings | 1 November – All Saints

First Reading: Revelation 7:2–4, 9–14 • Psalm: 24:1–2, 3–4, 5–6
Second Reading: 1 John 3:1–3 • Gospel: Matthew 5:1–12

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: St Otteran, monk • Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles
Thursday: St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop • Friday: St John of Capistrano, priest
Saturday: St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Prayer, Worship & Vocations

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "with the joy of the Holy Spirit" that they took to the Gospel. We pray for future priests of our diocese, that they will experience the joy of the Spirit as they read, live and preach the Good News of God's love.

Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours Tuesday 3 November and 1 December, 8–9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Priesthood? Meeting in Derry on Sunday 8 November at 4 pm. Contact Fr Pat O'Hagan, Diocesan Vocations Director: pgoh2111@gmail.com or (028) 7938 6259.

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets Wednesday 28 October, 12.30–1.30 pm, at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas at Long Tower Church, Derry, 6 pm, beginning Sunday 25 October. Theme: "Make Me a Channel of Your Peace – Celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis." Each night includes the Rosary, Novena prayers and petitions, a guest talk, Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and Benediction. All welcome, especially those in need of healing. Webcam: https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Parish & Diocesan Events

6–8 NOV	**A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett** Termonbacca, Derry. Prayer, reflection and an opportunity to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact: termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or facebook.com/TermonbaccaDerry/
15 NOV	**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group – Golden Jubilee** Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing at Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration 9.30 am; concluding with afternoon Mass. Theme: "People of God's Delight" (Ps 149:4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. £40 including coffee and lunch. Book by 1 November: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.
19 NOV	**The Columban Young Adults – Holy Hour & Meditation** 7 pm, Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry. For ages 18–35. Meditation by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. New members welcome. Contact: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com.
20–22 NOV	**Abide Women's Conference** Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and the Nashville Dominicans. Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. Registration: Abide in His Love on Eventbrite.ie.
5 DEC	**St Patrick's, Dungannon – Charismatic Prayer Group Golden Jubilee** Servite Priory, Benburb, 11 am–3 pm, concluding with Mass. Theme: "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come." Everyone welcome.

Marriage & Family Life

ACCORD Derry – Marriage Preparation Courses In-person at the Everglades Hotel, Derry. Dates: 29–30 January, 19–20 February and 19–20 March 2027. Book at www.accordni.com.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend St Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo, Friday 9–Sunday 11 April 2027. Residential weekend for married couples, beginning Friday at 7.30 pm and ending Sunday at 4.30 pm. Online booking only: www.marriageencounter.ie.

Job Opportunity

Choir Director – St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry Experienced Choir Director sought for 10 hours per week to lead the cathedral choir and enhance worship through music. Application pack: (028) 7126 2302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, or by email, by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer; applications from all communities welcome.

ARDMORE PARISH • Growing together in faith, hope and love.

BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES 25_OCTOBER_2026

No. 52 ~ THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PP VF
31 Sixtowns Road
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Email:ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Fr Michael McCaul CC
50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin
Telephone: 79632196
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen:

9 High Street
Phone: (028)79628248
Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**
Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and Thursday: 8.45 am - 3.30 pm. Wednesday: 8.45 am - 3.00 pm.

Desertmartin:

St Patrick's Keenaught
Phone: (028)79397047
Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**
Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30 am to 3.00 pm.

SAFEGUARDING

Safeguarding Contact Information

If you have any concerns with regard to the safeguarding of children within the Church, please contact:
Marie O'Kane - Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) Tel.: +44 7596 500793 or Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org
Northern Ireland Emergency Services

- PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101
- Social Services:
  - Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (ask for the Duty Social Worker)
  - Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459
  - Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995

LIFELINE

Tel: 0808 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808 808 8000.
www.lifelinehelpline.info

SVP HELPLINE

Helpline telephone number: 07710838050

GAMBLING HELPLINE

Help is available, phone: 02871351329

SPERRIN FOODBANK

Tel: 07543420639

BALLINASCREEN COMMUNITY SUPPORT GROUP

Please click the link https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-community-support-gro for full details of Ballinascreen Community Support Group.



NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices for the Bulletin should be received by 1.00 pm on Wednesday, preferably by email.

Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**

VIGIL MASSES FOR SUNDAY

Holy Rosary: 6.00 pm - DDS Mass

St Patrick's, Keenaught: **5.00 pm - NB Earlier Time**

SUNDAY MASSES

St Columba's, Straw: 9.00 am

St Mary's, Coolcalm: 10.00 am

St Patrick's, Sixtowns: 11.00 am

St Eugene's, Moneyneena: 12 noon

MASSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday ~ 26 October

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Tuesday ~ 27 October

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm - DDS Mass.

Wednesday ~ 28 October

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Thursday ~ 29 October

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

1.00 pm ~ Ballinascreen Fold Mass

Friday ~ 30 October

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary Church.

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen: Holy Rosary 5.30 pm - before Vigil Mass.

Desertmartin: Keenaught, Saturday 6.30 pm until 7.10 pm.

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Tuesday 27 October: St Otteran, monk.

Wednesday 28 October: Ss Simon and Jude.

Thursday 29 October: St Colman, bishop.

Saturday 31 October: Bl. Dominic Collins, martyr.

BALLINASCREEN FOLD

The FOLD Mass takes place on Thursday 29 October at 1.00 pm. All welcome.

D.D.S MASS

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20.

The following masses will be offered for the deceased members of the Derry Diocesan Society:

Tuesday 27 October at 10.00 am in St Mary's, Coolcalm;

Saturday 31 October at 6.00 pm in Holy Rosary.

HALLOWEEN WEEKEND MASSES AND ALL SOULS DAY

In order to accommodate families and the celebration of Halloween next Saturday October 31, Mass in Keenaught will be celebrated at 5.00 pm and not 7.30 pm. Mass in Holy Rosary will be at the usual time of 6.00 pm.

Please note the change of Mass times for Monday 2 November - All Souls Day:

7.00 am ~ Holy Rosary.
10.00 am ~ Coolcalm & Moneyneena.
11.00 am ~ Sixtowns.
7.30 pm ~ Straw.
7.30 pm ~ Keenaught.

ROME & ASSISI PILGRIMAGE

During their pilgrimage to Assisi and Rome pilgrims from Ballinascreen and Desermtartin, accompanied by Fr Madden will pray for all parishioners and Mass will be offered by Fr Madden on Sunday (Today) at the Tomb of St Carlo Acutis for the intentions of all.

DEATHS

We extend our prayerful sympathy to the family and relatives of:
Terry Hegarty, Ranaghan Road.

MONTH'S MIND MASS

The Month's Mind Mass for Cecilia Bradley, Gortnari will be held on Friday 30 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary Mass for John Joe Shaw, Grange Lane, will be held on Friday 6 November at 10.00 am in St Mary's Church, Coolcalm.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:
First Anniversaries:
Kevin Kelly, Bancran;
John Joe McKenna, Cloane.
Anniversaries:
Maureen McCullagh, Belfast;
Brigid McEldowney, Fivemilestraight;
Reece Kelly, Mallon Villas;
Daniel Doherty, Cloane Rd.;
Alice kelly, Magherafelt Rd.
Desertmartin:
Selina McElwee;
Ignatius Crawley;
Alphonsus Crawley,
Geraldine Hughes;
Francis Loane;
Alphonsus Shaw;
Henry McBride;
Baby Mary McBride;
James Connery.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:
Callie Sophia Flanaghan, Glenshane Park.

PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES WITH BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER

The Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lourdes led by **Bishop Michael Router** will take place in **July 2027.** There are **TWO** possible travel arrangements available to all pilgrims. A group will depart from **City of Derry Airport on Thursday 8 July 2027 and return to City of Derry Airport on Tuesday 13 July 2027.** A second group will depart from **Belfast Airport on Wednesday 7 July and return to Belfast Airport on Wednesday 14 July.** Any pilgrim interested in going should leave their name, contact details and flight preference with either **Fr Michael McCaul, Fr Peter Madden or in the Parish Offices** as soon as possible. Please note that the pilgrimage last year was **sold out** in 10 days.

ANNUAL SOLEMN NOVENA

In honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00 pm, beginning this Sunday 25 October. *'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'*. Each night will comprise of the